LESSON 1.3 | Lesson notes

Common Vulnerabilities

Overview

A vulnerability is a weakness an attacker can use. Typical ones are weak or reused passwords, software that has not been updated, data sent without encryption, programs that trust user input and systems that give users more permissions than they need. Most successful attacks use well-known problems rather than clever new ones. Lists such as the OWASP Top Ten describe the most frequent web vulnerabilities, and learning them is the quickest way to stop writing code that attackers expect.

Key points

- Part of: Security Fundamentals
- About 20 minutes
- Try the example yourself, then check it

How to use this handout

1. Read the overview first, then work through the key points in order.
2. Write down anything you are unsure about and ask in the course forum.
3. Use page 2 to plan your practice and keep notes.

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Practice checklist

- [ ] Read: Common Vulnerabilities
- [ ] Try the example from the lesson
- [ ] Explain the main idea in your own words
- [ ] Answer the related questions
- [ ] Ask about anything unclear in the forum

My notes